

Master's Capstone Project

Week 2 Class Activity: Sprint 1 Readiness Studio

Connected to: Assessment 1 — Week 3 Sprint Review

Duration: 90 minutes

Workshop purpose

Use software-process concepts to prepare a defensible Sprint 1 plan and evidence trail. By the end of class, your team should be able to begin implementation and explain what will be demonstrated in Week 3.

AT1 Sprint 1 target: User registration and login, validation of mandatory fields, and clear feedback for missing or invalid information. If this is not relevant to your project, define an equivalent demonstrable increment and confirm approval with the Lecturer in Charge.

Team details

Team	Project	Sprint coordinator	Date

90-minute sequence

Time	Team task	Concrete output
0–10	Confirm the AT1 target and approved requirements	Agreed increment and source requirements
10–25	Write the Sprint 1 goal and success evidence	One-sentence goal and observable outcome
25–45	Select backlog items and acceptance criteria	Prioritised backlog with testable criteria
45–60	Tailor process; map architecture, roles and risks	Process rationale, owners and controls
60–75	Design test evidence and the live demonstration	Normal, error and boundary cases; demo path
75–85	Conduct a peer sprint-readiness review	One strength, one risk and one required revision
85–90	Commit the next 48-hour actions	Named actions, owners and deadlines

Open before starting: AT1 guide, approved scope and requirements, project plan, sprint board, repository, current architecture/design model, and risk register.

Sprint 1 Planning Canvas

Phase 1: Confirm scope and write the sprint goal (0–25 minutes)

A useful goal names the user, the capability, and the observable outcome. It is not a task list.

Prompt	Team response
Target user and problem	
Sprint 1 increment	Registration/login or approved equivalent:
Sprint goal	By the end of Sprint 1, [user] can [capability], demonstrated by [observable evidence].
Out of scope	

Phase 2: Select backlog items and acceptance criteria (25–45 minutes)

Select only work that contributes to a demonstrable vertical slice. Link each item to an approved functional requirement or record the justified change.

ID	Backlog item	Requirement link	Owner / reviewer	Demo evidence
1				
2				
3				
4				

Write acceptance criteria before implementation. Include behaviour for valid, missing, invalid and boundary inputs where relevant.

Selected item	Normal behaviour	Error / boundary behaviour	Evidence captured when done
	Given / When / Then:	Given / When / Then:	
	Given / When / Then:	Given / When / Then:	
	Given / When / Then:	Given / When / Then:	

Definition of done: Integrated into the agreed branch; reviewed; tested against acceptance criteria; free of exposed secrets; demonstrable from a known start state; evidence stored in a location the whole team can access.

Process, Risk and Evidence Canvas

Phase 3: Tailor the process and allocate ownership (45–60 minutes)

Do not write only 'we use Agile'. State which practice controls which uncertainty or risk, and what evidence the practice will leave.

Decision prompt	Team decision and rationale
Uncertainty / criticality	What is uncertain? What harm follows from failure or misuse?
Process and feedback cadence	Which lifecycle practices and review/build cadence fit this sprint, and why?
Architecture and dependencies	Where does the feature fit? Which interfaces, data, services or approvals constrain it?
AT1 explanation	First law: problem, users, current process, rules and constraints. Second law: usability and maintainability. Common-good issue: ethics, accessibility, privacy or security.
Ownership and review	Who implements, reviews, tests, integrates and prepares evidence?

Top sprint risks

Risk	Early warning / trigger	Response or experiment	Owner

Phase 4: Design test evidence and the live demonstration (60–75 minutes)

Case	Input / precondition	Expected observable result	Evidence location
Normal / successful			
Error / invalid			
Boundary / unexpected			

Demonstration plan	Team response
Known start state	
Steps and speaker	
Visible success claim	
Backup and code version	Video/screenshots location; repository tag/commit:

Sprint 1 Readiness Gate

Phase 5: Peer review (75–85 minutes)

Present in-class / Exchange plans with another team. The purpose is to find problems before implementation consumes the sprint.

Readiness criterion	Ready / Rework	Reviewer evidence or required revision
Goal is specific, bounded and demonstrable in Week 3		
Registration/login or an approved equivalent is clearly scoped		
Backlog items link to approved requirements		
Acceptance criteria cover normal, error and boundary behaviour		
Architecture touchpoints, dependencies and owners are visible		
Process choices respond to uncertainty, risk and feedback needs		
Live demo, backup evidence and repository version are planned		
Every member has a contribution and can explain the work		

Peer feedback: one strength:

Peer feedback: one risk or missing evidence:

Phase 6 — Commit the next 48-hour actions (85–90 minutes)

Action	Owner	Deadline	Evidence of completion

Exit statement: Because our Sprint 1 risk or uncertainty is _____, we will use _____ practice, and we will know the increment is ready when _____.